commenced on 10 February, followed the laid-down Steps and was completed by 19 February. I was able to report the same to the RM who was extremely pleased and asked me to convey his compliments and best wishes to everyone who had participated in Operation Snow Leopard.

Talks continued thereafter at regular intervals, with no untoward incidents in the disengagement areas. PP-17A was settled after the twelfth round of talks held in July 2021 and disengagement was completed by 5 August.[23] The disengagement at PP-15 happened only much later, in September 2022 (after I had retired), as a result of the agreement reached in the sixteenth round of Corps Commander-level talks.[24] In hindsight, it was a wise decision to go ahead with the disengagement in the North and South Banks of the Pangong Tso. Since Parliament was in session in February, it was incumbent on us to inform Parliament first, before releasing anything to the media to avoid a breach of privilege. When and how to do this was critical. The Rajya Sabha was to meet on the 11th morning, and the Lok Sabha on the 11th evening. The RM was of the opinion that he should address the Lok Sabha first followed by the Rajya Sabha the next day. There was a proposal to inform the Parliament on the 10th itself, since the disengagement had already commenced, but we did not want it to clash with the PM's Vote of Thanks on the President's address. So, it was decided to go ahead with the 11th morning and we got around to preparing the draft for the RM. The humorous part was that while we were doing this in strict secrecy, it was the Chinese side that broke the news of the disengagement at about 1600 hours IST (on the 10th) on the *Global Times* as well as their Twitter handle. Our media houses and channels went sort of berserk, wondering how they had not come to know of it. We were inundated with a large number of calls, with ADG PI getting more than eighty calls

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